



Message from the Provost

As 2023 draws to a close, I thank each of you for all you've done this year for our students, our University and each other. This year was full of amazing achievements and milestones that we have highlighted in our newsletters and Town Hall meetings. DeVry Academics is at the forefront of innovation for the University. In particular, advances in AI technology will shape our innovation in the coming years. I hope you enjoy some well-deserved time off and spend time reflecting upon your achievements and contributions in 2023. Looking forward to an outstanding and exciting 2024. Cheers!

-Shantanu Bose

Upcoming Events

January 22-25	HLC multi-location site visits: Arlington, VA; Columbus, OH; and Decatur, GA
March 6-8	ACBSP site visit: Lisle, IL
April 1	HLC campus visit: Lisle, IL
December 9-10	HLC Midpoint Comprehensive visit: Lisle, IL

Voice of the Student



Here's what students are saying about their incredible professors:

"Professor [Veronica] Schreiber's videos (week 4 overviews and objectives) are absolutely brilliant. I watched them so many times I was almost confident I could do Algebra."

"Professor [Hatshepsitu] Tull was very patient with me. She encouraged me and believed in me. I was really struggling with this course, but she was there to guide me."

"I have learned a lot from **[Professor James Schneider]**. He always encouraged me to do better and made me realize my potential in writing. He is, so far, the best teacher I have had."

"Professor [Theresa] Jenkins was amazing! She led conversations with all the students in the weekly discussions and always came back to respond to any questions. She has been the best professor so far in my experience with DeVry!"

"[Professor Mohamed Brihoum] is one of the best teachers I have had in my entire life. During my time at DeVry I have been exposed to different styles of teaching. I am truly grateful for his time and patience with me. He really makes you feel like he wants the best for you."

"I really learned a lot in this class. I like how **Professor [Robert] Davy** had the recordings to help us with our homework and quiz. He demonstrated with charts in Excel. I had never used Excel in this capacity but now I will never forget and I'll be able to use this with calculating data at my job. He made it easy to understand. I give him 20 stars and more."

"Professor Yu On Ng is one of the finest professors and has exceeded my expectations by a million times. If I needed help, he would help me immediately, telling me where to improve and what I needed to follow up on with extra studying."

Welcome and Congratulations!

New Full-time Colleague

Michelle Cranney, Associate Professor

Full-time-colleague Promotions

Shad Koros to Assistant Professor

Sheila Sampath to Professor

Susan Kennedy to Faculty Chair



"I'm back home and I got a nice job as a logistics coordinator. I also have a roof over my head and money in the bank! Thanks, **[Professor Paula Herring]**, for helping me out along the way!"

"I have struggled with mathematics in the past. **Professor [Makrina] Feagins** has not only removed limitations on what I can learn, but also emphasized that the only limitations we face are within ourselves. Her compassion, empathy and dedication to her students go beyond the classroom."

"I do not say this lightly: This was the *best* math class I have ever taken. **Professor [Louis] Freese** absolutely knocked it out of the park with making sure class was engaging and informative, and he was always open/available for questions."

"Thanks to your class, I was able to go into the test with a clear understanding of our codebooks. **[Professor Jennifer Sanders]** helped me feel more confident, and I was able to pass on the first try."

Program Updates

November Session Implementation

Our most recent program implementation, during the November session, marked the first wave of AI curriculum enhancements – enhancements we're confident will help position DVU as an education solution for closing the emerging AI skills gap.

New AI and Data Analytics courses were added to our bachelor's degree programs in Computer Information Systems, Information Technology & Networking, and Software Development. Our Data Mining & Analytics undergraduate certificate program was also updated.

January Session Implementation

January 15 is a BIG DAY! That's when long-awaited and strategic modifications and enhancements will go live for programs in our Health Information stack – Medical Billing & Coding (MBC), MBC – Health Information Coding, Health Information Technology (HIT) and Technical Management – Health Information Management. Enhancements include:

- Establishing a new introductory health course, HIT101, and the four-course Digital Health Core sequence.
- Reducing credit hours in certain programs to lower students' program costs and completion times.
- Revamping the coding course sequence and content to enhance student learning.
- Expanding the HIT program with three additional (new) track options beyond the Health Information (coding) track.
- Integrating Career Services touch points to enhance student success.
- Concluding each program with a certification-content-review course.



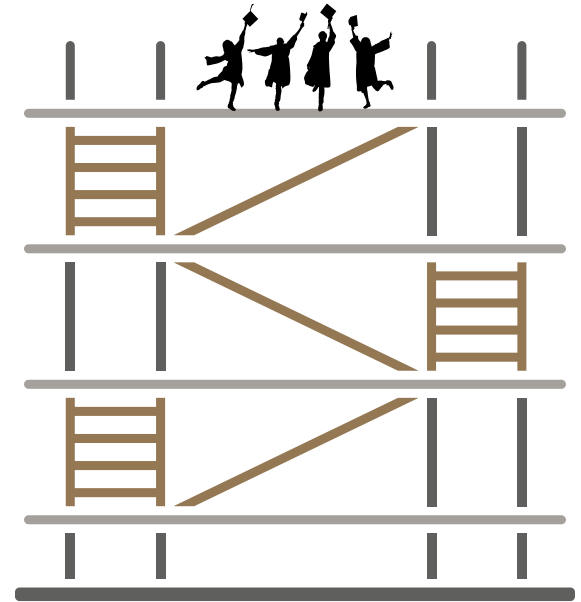
Learn more in our College of Health Sciences updates.

College of Health Sciences

New Health Information Programs Launching

Recruitment for our new Health Information programs begins next month, with students starting classes in the March session. In response to industry, faculty and student feedback, considerable revisions have been made to our Medical Billing & Coding (MBC) and MBC – Health Information Coding undergraduate certificate programs, and to our associate degree program in Health Information Technology (AHIT) and bachelor's degree program in Technical Management – Health Information Management (BSTM – HIM). Highlights include:

- **New Course – HIT101: Professional Skills for Healthcare.** Helps prepare students for academic success; includes special Healthcare New Student Orientation.
- **New 4-Course Digital Health Core.** Helps students develop interdisciplinary skills for the rapidly evolving health information field and provides hands-on experience. New and revised courses, HIT111, HIT125, HIT223 and HIT235, go live in the DeVry catalog on January 15.
- **Coding Restructure.** Coding curriculum sequenced and improved to provide outpatient and inpatient tracks, and up-to-date coding scenario experiences.
- **New MBC Certification Focus.** AAPC Certified Professional Coder (CPC) certification topics incorporated; plan of study includes review course integrating domain exam practice and practicum experience.
- **New AHIT Tracks.** Three additional tracks – Analytics, IT & Cybersecurity and General Health Services – join Health Information track, which provides more choices for students.



Career Services Academic Event Scaffolding Project

CoHS colleagues partnered with the Career Services team to develop timely and intentional academic events throughout our healthcare programs. Academic events are tied to career-related tasks and milestones along the student educational journey. The project will go live in the March 2024 session.

Questions and/or interested in learning more? Email Dr. Laura Kathryn Neal, dean of the College of Health Sciences (Laura.Neal@devry.edu).



College of Business & Management

College of Liberal Arts & Sciences

DeVry University Student Chapter Receives Merit Award from SHRM

In August this year, the Society for Human Resource Management (SHRM) awarded a 2022-2023 SHRM Merit Award designation to DeVry's SHRM student chapter, led by Dr. Linda Wayerski, for providing superior growth and development opportunities to student members. "Leading our SHRM student chapter members is such a pleasure and adds another dimension to my work. I commend the students on their dedication to, and enthusiasm for, HR. I know the future of the profession is in good hands," says Wayerski.

The Merit Award program encourages development of more effective student chapters and distinguishes outstanding activities and projects. Chapters are recognized based on operations, chapter programming, professional development of members, support of the HR profession and SHRM engagement. SHRM student chapters have the opportunity to earn an award based on the number of activities completed during the Merit Award cycle, the most recent of which was May 2022 through April 2023.



Business Program Accreditation Update

This academic year, our undergraduate and graduate business degree programs, and business graduate certificate programs, are up for reaffirmation by the Accreditation Council for Business Schools and Programs (ACBSP). As part of the reaffirmation process, we submitted an extensive self-study report in July this year. ACBSP will also conduct an in-person visit at the home office, in Lisle, IL, in March 2024. Thank you to all who contributed to the self-study and to all who will offer support as we prepare for the visit.

Expanding BUSN062

In this year's spring newsletter, we shared news about piloting transitional studies course BUSN062, Introduction to Business Communication. During the pilot, launched in the September 2022 session, BUSN062 replaced ENGL062 (Introduction to Reading and Writing) for students in the Business Essentials undergraduate certificate program and those in the associate degree program in Business Administration who place below standard on the reading and writing placement exam. The pilot has concluded with positive outcomes, and BUSN062 has now been adopted as the transitional studies reading and writing course for these programs! We're also excited to expand adoption of BUSN062 by all College of Business & Management bachelor's degree program students who place at the transitional studies level.

Calling All Creatives!

Have creative work – a photo, story, painting, poem, video, etc. – stored on your phone or buried deep in your computer? Let your inner creative out! The [DeVry Creative LibGuide](#) is a great place to showcase your work. Check out the LibGuide for more on how to submit your material.

College of Engineering & Information Sciences

College of Media Arts & Technology

Accreditation Update

DeVry received official notice that the Engineering Technology Accreditation Commission (ETAC) of ABET granted our bachelor's (BS) and associate (AAS) degree programs in Engineering Technology (BET and AET) six years of accreditation, with one additional year of retroactive accreditation for the AAS degree. ETAC of ABET found *no findings* with these programs! Our Engineering Technology legacy programs retain accreditation during their teach-out.

Additionally, the National Security Agency and a committee of academic peers validated the program of study for our Bachelor of Science in Computer Information Systems with Specialization in Cyber Security Programming through academic year 2028! The institutional application, due mid-January next year, is the final step toward approval for Cybersecurity Academic Excellence!

Finally, reviewers from the Computing Accreditation Commission (CAC) of ABET visited our main campus earlier this month and reviewed our bachelor's degree programs in Software Development (BSD) and Information Technology & Networking (BITN). This is the first time DeVry has sought CAC of ABET accreditation which, when received, will be a new accreditation for these programs. Thanks to many colleagues and faculty, the visit went very well! The final decision will be issued by the ABET board next August.

Industry/Workforce Engagement

DeVry's National Advisory Committee (NAC) meetings this fall reviewed programs in the engineering technology, software and information systems, and information technology and networking disciplines. A NAC reviewing our cybersecurity offerings is scheduled next month.

In November, DVU participated in the first CompTIA Tech Workforce Educational Fly-in, where 90 CompTIA partners and staff gathered in Washington, DC, to discuss critical tech workforce issues and educate policymakers on the unique pathways people can take to enter the tech workforce. Deans Bill Phillips and Sarah Dubowsky, along with Rhaslyn McGhee, national director of scholarship programs, attended the event, where they addressed rapid changes in tech fields, and advocated for streamlined program and curriculum approvals and work-based learning initiatives to support DVU's career-focused mission.



(L to R): Dr. Bill Phillips, Dr. Sarah Dubowsky and Dr. Rhaslyn McGhee meet with CompTIA partner in Washington, DC.

THANK YOU

to the incredible cross-functional team of colleagues that helped make the recent ABET site visit a huge success!

Curriculum

To support emerging AI technologies in tech fields, five new AI-focused courses relevant to different tech programs are in development and slated to launch in our spring sessions:

- CIS313: AI-Driven Business Application Coding
- MIS548: AI Applications for Technology Management
- SEC313: Applied AI for Cybersecurity
- TECH212: Introduction to Artificial Intelligence Applications
- TECH408: Applied AI for Management and Technology

Student Professional Development

DVU continues to host cohorts of students through the National Cyber League Competition, where students work to solve cyber challenges against other participating schools. During the fall 2023 competition, DeVry students placed 33rd out of the nearly 4,700 schools competing!

DeVry held its fourth Community of Practice event in October, with the focus on AI and its impact on the future of tech careers. The half-day symposium featured industry subject matter experts as speakers and panelists. Participants provided students, alumni and faculty insights into AI skill needs.

Scholar Spotlight

Congratulations to these distinguished faculty members on their recent achievements! Be sure to share your recently completed scholarly endeavor to be considered for a future publication by emailing ScholarSpotlight@DeVry.edu.



Dr. Ewa Schmitz was a keynote speaker in the United Nations Commission for the Status of Women 67 workshop entitled *Youth Speak! Equality Through Innovative Technologies that Support Global Education*. The youth-led event, featuring intergenerational perspectives, focused on technology innovations and new models that blend peace education with STEM learning through partnerships that empower and advance global equality of women and girls.



In November, **Debbie Kean** co-presented at the American Mathematical Association of Two-Year Colleges, in Omaha, NE. This year's conference theme was Math's a Hit! In an edutainment vein, she demonstrated "Your Guide to Monthly Math Holiday Feasting." Says Kean, "Decisions in life are often based on numerical information, so students need to be numerate in order to make the best choices. Mixing math with food can whet their appetite for more numeracy-rich lessons."



Linh Luong will serve as a GAC (Global Accreditation Center for Project Management Education Programs) director in 2024. As a GAC director, Luong will be part of GAC's governing body, with responsibilities including making policy decisions, reviewing university self-assessment reports, working with site visit team leads to plan visits and making GAC accreditation decisions. GAC is the accrediting body of our Project Management programs.



Dr. Emre Ozmen recently had his paper accepted for publication with the International Journal of Strategic Property Management. The article, *Sustainability in Property Taxation: An Application for Revenue Stability and Fairness Perspectives*, aims to scrutinize current practices that are mainly dominated by uncontrollable attributes, such as assessment-based taxation, and suggests inclusion of controllable attributes to favor better sustainability.



Dr. Laura Kathryn Neal earned her Fellow of the American Academy of Healthcare Executives certification in April. The FACHE credential provides recognition as a leader among leaders in healthcare management, demonstrates competency in all areas of healthcare management, and signifies lifelong commitment to change and improvement.



In August, **Dr. Neisa Jenkins** was honored to receive the 2023 Distinguished Service Award from the Georgia Health Information Management Association during the annual meeting.



Dr. Kim Lamana-Finn presented a session entitled *Exploring Associations Between Relationship Quality, Student Engagement, and Student Loyalty*, to faculty and academic administrators at HLC's Annual Conference.

Winter Milestone Anniversaries

1

Amy Tidwell

Andrew Black
Ashley Collier
Benita Williams
Benkam Benedict Bobga
Carlisa Vinson
Cynthia Krupa
Dana Barfield
Douglas Mitchell
Erica Wilson
George Shamshayooadeh
Jenna Bishop-Beall
Judith Anderson
Julia Kirkland
Karissa Dahlke
Kevin Scahill
Kingsley Opara
LaQuata Sumter
Lisa Longwell-Willis
Mandy Reavis
Marie-Anne Boyard
Maignan
Mark Rasiah
Omar Haddad
Paramdeep Saini
Patricia Black
Patricia Brockman
Rexford Okrah
Ruei-Lan Su
Sandra Goddard
Stefanie Khan
Sumudu Kalubowila
Tanya Dundas
TorQuailla Aultman
Tracy West
Vicki Bealman

5

Ana Everett
Douglas Gentile
Elsa Nickl
Faizan Seedat
Lynda Nguyen
Madeline Shorter-Hall
Marilyn Taylor
Neiger Green
Nicholaus Nelson-Goedert
Nichole Armand
Shad Koros
Shawn Smith
Walfyette Powell
Wanda Carter-Calhoun

10

Amin Ghanei
Angelia Hamilton
Catherine Garcia
Charles Richardson
Christa Richie
Christopher McFarlin
Crystal Saylor
Cynthia Caruso
Cynthia Stephen
Dalisa Rosado
Daniel Martinez
Didem Yamak Congress
Elliot Masocha
Evan Escobedo
Gillian Coote Martin
Gregory Morgan
Grover McDaniel
Jennifer Erpelding
Joe Njoloma
John St. John
Karina Kasztelnik
Mack Jackson
Matthew Keogh
Megan Patton
Ming Qian
Nabeel Khan
Nomita Yadav
Pat Williams
Rhonda Jones
Richard Moazzam
Rodney Robinson
Shantanu Bose
Simon Wahla
Stephanie Kern
Theresa Maia

15

Anne Poe
Aprille Woodson
Beth Drake
Bethany Mueller
Brian Gilligan
Clinton Emry
Damarie Grunauer
Daudi Langat
Diane Cropp
Diane Crowell
Dino Sgambellone
Donald McCubbrey
Donna Falloon
Donna Tersisky
Elizabeth Anderson
Ercleo Esquejo
Hamid Jafari
Heidi Clarke
Jacqueline Spence
Jennifer Frere
Jennifer Lame
Jon Backman
Joy Harrison
Keith Dixon
Leslie Ann Dunn
Linda Beauregard-Vasquez
Martin Telezing
Michelle Levack
Najib Kalai
Pamella Robinson
Patricia Anderson
Roderick Bell
Ronita Brooks
Roselyn Aker-Black
Roxanne Wittkamp
Sandra Angelo
Sarah Linsner
Tawanna Hall
William Garrison
Yvette Ricks
Zakevia Green-Lawson

20

Andrew Merczak
Bill Schwarz
Craig Nathanson
Dale Deardorff
Lauren Deane
Suga Suganthan
William Dillon

25

Ellen Jones
Hei Chan
Joseph Louderback
Michael Gooch
Saeed Jellouli
Sean Wright

30

Alex Leung
Mohamed Brihoum

35

Lorenzo Bowman

40

Bhupinder Sran
Kevin Greshock
Kim Lamana-Finn

Note: Visiting professor names are listed in black.

Accreditation News

Accreditation for the Win!

Google “Accreditation” and you get this: *Official certification that a school or course has met standards set by external regulators.* The external regulators below recently reviewed and officially determined DeVry has met their rigorous standards. Good for our students. Good for our reputation.

ETAC of ABET

- Accreditor visit: October 2022
- Outcomes report and reaffirmation letter: August 2023
- Programmatic accreditation through **2029**
- **Reaffirmation of accreditation:** Engineering Technology bachelor’s degree
- **New accreditation!** Engineering Technology associate degree

PMI GAC

- Accreditor visit: February 2023
- Outcomes notification: April 2023
- Programmatic accreditation December 2022–**November 2027: Reaffirmation of accreditation** for all Keller and DeVry Project Management (PM) programs and concentrations, as noted in [our Academic Catalogs](#).
- KUDOS! Our PM programs earned a **“Distinguished”** rating related to Curricula and Core Areas of Focus for Program Learning Outcomes. Reviewers observed above-and-beyond practices in PM curriculum development and deployment!

National Accreditation and Equivalency Council of The Bahamas

DeVry has maintained NAECOB recognition since 2019, each year submitting to the Council a report outlining our programs and operations. Year-over-year recognition has led to year-over-year enrollment growth, thanks to collaboration between DeVryWorks and Academics. Total enrollment from The Bahamas has grown from 5 in the May 2019 session to **136** in the November 2023 session.

Additionally, earlier this month **CAC of ABET** reviewers were at our main campus in Lisle, IL, to review our bachelor’s degree programs in Information Technology & Networking and Software Development, which are seeking **initial accreditation**. The outcomes report is expected next August.